cardlio

User Handbook

cardlio turns business cards into clean, structured contacts — entirely on your device. Scan with the camera, import photos, or paste an email signature; review the result; then export to Contacts, a spreadsheet, or your CRM. This handbook walks through every feature on **iPhone, iPad, and Mac**.

What's inside

1. The main window & toolbar
2. Getting started — capturing a card
3. Reviewing & editing a scan
4. Following up
5. Leads & keeping in touch
6. Double-sided cards
7. Screenshots of signatures, chats and profiles
8. QR codes and NFC cards you receive
9. How recognition works
10. Addresses & the map
11. Network stats
12. AI refinement
13. Exports — Contacts, CSV & Salesforce
14. Keeping the library current
15. Coming from another app
16. Backing up your library
17. Office 365 & Contacts sync
18. Team library
19. Ask your network
20. Google Contacts sync
21. Send cards to your CRM
22. Caller ID — who's calling
23. iCloud sync
24. Your cards in a browser
25. Sharing your card — link, QR, NFC, Wallet & signature
26. Siri, Shortcuts & Control Center
27. Voice notes
28. The in-app handbook
29. Privacy & your data
30. Tips & troubleshooting

The main window & toolbar

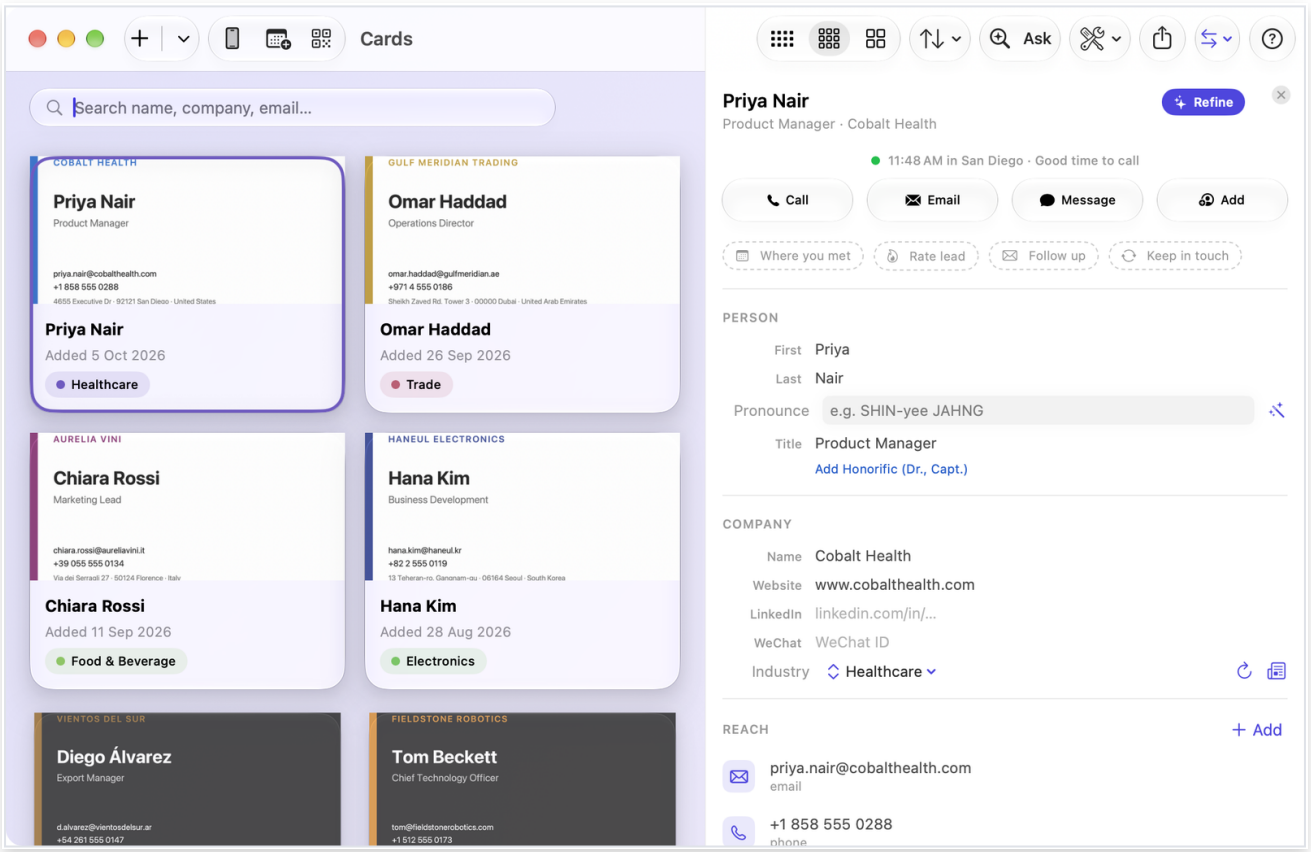
The main window is your card library. On **Mac** it's a resizable gallery of card tiles — the toolbar's grid control switches between three tile sizes, so you can browse cards big or fit a whole library on screen. On **iPhone and iPad** everything lives in a tab bar — **Cards**, **Map**, **Stats**, **My Card**, and a dedicated **Search** tab — with the capture actions floating just above it. Search by name, company, city, or email at any time — and as you type, cardlio suggests **filter tokens** for countries, companies, and industries, so a country name can mean "cards from that country" rather than cards containing the word. Names in Chinese, Japanese, or Korean are also findable **typed in the Latin alphabet** — searching "shiquan" finds 黎士銓 — so you never have to switch keyboards to reach a card.

Scanning at a conference? Start **Event mode** (More menu on iPhone, the calendar toolbar button on Mac), name the event once, and every card you scan is tagged with it until you end it — filter your library by event later, and follow-up drafts open with "great to meet you at…". The tag is editable on any card.

Forgot to start it — or scanned the stack on the flight home? You can tag cards **after the fact, in bulk**. On **Mac**, select the cards in the gallery, right-click, and choose **Tag Event…**. On **iPhone and iPad**, More menu → **Select Multiple…**, tick the cards, then **Tag Event**. Leaving the name empty clears the tag instead. This is the one path that overwrites a tag already there, because you asked for it by name.

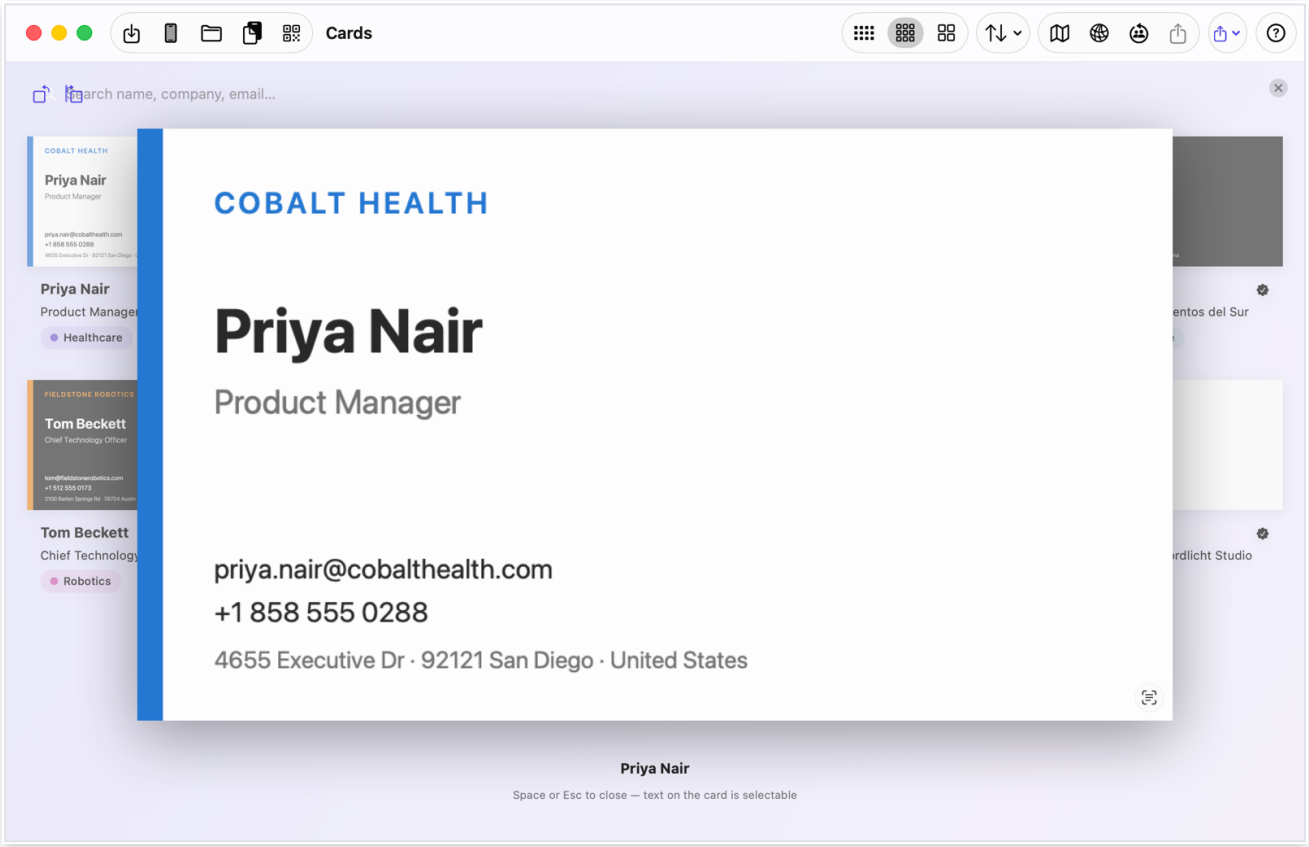
After the fair: the follow-up run. On the **Mac**, **File → Follow-Up Run…** (⇧⌘U), on **iPhone and iPad** the More menu → **Follow-Up Run…**, takes you through everyone from one event, one person at a time. Each gets a drafted email — written on your device by Apple Intelligence where it is available, a short plain draft otherwise — which you can edit, then **Open in Mail** hands it to your own mail app (Mail, Outlook, whichever you use) to send. **Done & Next** marks the follow-up done and moves on; **Skip** leaves it. People you have already followed up are left out, and a card without an email can still be marked done. cardlio itself sends nothing.

The event report. Many people who staff a stand have to report their leads to someone. **Event Report…** (Mac: File menu or Tools; iPhone and iPad: More menu) puts one fair on a page: everyone you met there, hot leads first, then warm, cold and unrated, each with title, company, email, phone, your rating, their interests, whether you still owe a follow-up and the first line of your notes. **Export PDF** gives an A4 document to send on; **Export CSV** the same rows for a spreadsheet or CRM. Exporting is part of the unlock, like every export.



The Mac library. Each tile shows the card image, the person, and when the card was added (or where you met); click a tile to edit it in the panel beside the gallery.

The Mac gallery is fully keyboard-navigable: arrow keys move the selection, typing a name jumps straight to it, **Space** shows the card big, ⌫ deletes (after confirming), and **⌘F** jumps to search. The enlarged preview doubles as the photo workbench: the card is Live Text (select and copy anything printed on it), the arrow keys flip through cards while it's open, and its buttons rotate the card, open **Edit photo** — crop, brightness, contrast, saturation — and show the raw OCR text. Rotate and Edit Photo are also in every card's right-click menu.



The gallery preview: Space enlarges the selected card, with Live Text on the photo.

The toolbar gathers every action. Related buttons are grouped into segments; the **Help** button sits on its own at the trailing edge so it's always easy to find.



The Mac toolbar. Left to right: Add (files, a pasted signature or another app's export), Scan with iPhone, Event & My Card, tile size & sort, Ask, the Tools menu, Share, Import & Export — and the separated Help (?) button.

- **Add** — click it to bring in card photos or PDFs; its arrow also offers **Paste Signature** and **Import from Another App**. On the Mac you can also drag files into the window, drop them on cardlio's **Dock icon**, right-click a file in Finder and pick **Open With → cardlio**, or drag a block of **selected text** (an email signature) into the window to extract a card from it.
- **Two-sided cards** — in the review screen, tap ··· → **Scan the Back** on a card (iPhone) to scan its BACK: its details merge into the same contact instead of becoming a duplicate. A Japanese front and English back combine cleanly — the second-language name is kept as an alternate, and a translated company name lands in the notes. On the Mac, right-click a saved card and choose **Add Card Back…**.
- **Scan with iPhone** — use your iPhone or iPad as the Mac's camera (see the capture chapter).
- **Ask** — ask your network a question in plain language.
- **Tools** — **Map**, **Stats**, **Find Duplicates** and the **Team Library**.
- **Share / Export** — send a single card or export the whole library.
- **Help (?)** — opens the in-app handbook (a shorter version of this document).

Deleting is safe: on iPhone and iPad an **Undo** button appears for a few seconds before the delete becomes final (deletes sync to all your devices), and on the Mac a confirmation asks first. On iOS, your contacts also appear in **system Search (Spotlight)** — tapping a result opens the card directly.

An orange **pin with a slash** beside a card means Apple Maps couldn't find its address — open the card to check it. Under each card the iPhone list shows the company and, when set, where you met; a Mac tile says where you met or when the card was added.

Getting started — capturing a card

There are several ways to bring a card into cardlio. All recognition happens on-device, so you can scan anywhere, online or off.

Camera & AR scanner (iPhone / iPad)

Two ways to capture, for two situations. **Scan** takes one card at a time, like a document scanner: point at a card, capture with edge detection, and keep going to build a batch — best for a few cards. **AR Scan** takes many at once: spread a stack on the table, and the live view draws a box around every card it sees; when the boxes turn green, tap the shutter — or turn on **Auto-capture** (the camera-with-clock button) and it fires by itself a second after the cards hold steady. An amber capsule warns while the shot would come out poorly — too far away, too dark, glare, or blur — and Auto-capture waits until it clears; the shutter button always works. The **bolt** button turns on the torch, and cardlio remembers it for the next scan. Rotated or skewed cards are straightened for you, a card photographed in poor light is brightened so its paper looks white (after the text is read, so no field changes), and a progress card shows which card cardlio is reading while the batch processes — on iPhone the same progress also lives in the **Dynamic Island** and on the Lock Screen, so you can flip to another app while a big batch finishes.



Screenshot unavailable — the live camera and AR scanner can only be captured on a physical device.

Stopping a scan

A big batch — or a PDF with more pages than you meant to drop in — can be stopped: the progress shows a **Stop** button (in the footer on the Mac, on the scan overlay on iPhone and iPad). Nothing you have already read is thrown away: the cards recognised so far go to the review screen as usual, with **Scan stopped — review 6 cards** above them, and the rest of the pages are simply never started. Stopping is always safe; nothing has been saved to your library yet at that point.

Scan with iPhone (Mac)

The Mac can borrow your iPhone's camera: click **Scan with iPhone** in the toolbar, pick your device, and take the photo (or scan a stack with **Scan Documents**) on the phone — the capture lands straight in the Mac's scan pipeline, no cables or AirDrop involved. Your iPhone just needs to be nearby, on the same Apple ID, with Wi-Fi and Bluetooth on.

With **Event mode** on, the AR scanner shows the event name in the corner, so you can see at a glance that everything you're shooting is being tagged — and the review screen confirms it with **Tagged GITEX 2026** above the batch.

Conference badges

Badges scan the same way cards do — point the scanner at one and it lands in the review screen like anything else. Two kinds are common at events, and both work.

- **Badges with a QR code that carries the contact.** cardlio reads it and fills the fields straight from the code, so nothing depends on reading the print. Name, title, company, email and phone arrive exactly as the organiser entered them.
- **Badges whose QR is only an attendee number.** Many events now encode a registration ID rather than the person, precisely so a photo of a badge cannot be harvested. cardlio simply reads the badge as printed — name, job title and company come off the front, the same way they would off a card. Email and phone are usually not printed on a badge, so those stay empty until you add them.

A badge is bigger than a card and mostly whitespace, which is fine — what matters is that the whole badge is in frame and roughly square-on.

- **Take it out of the lanyard sleeve if you can.** Clear plastic under venue lighting produces glare, and glare is the one thing that reliably defeats any scanner. If the badge cannot come out, tilt it away from the light rather than moving closer.
- Badges that curl inside their pouch read better flattened for the second it takes to shoot.
- With **Event mode** on, every badge you scan is tagged with the event name — which is exactly what you want at a conference, where the badges and the event are the same thing.

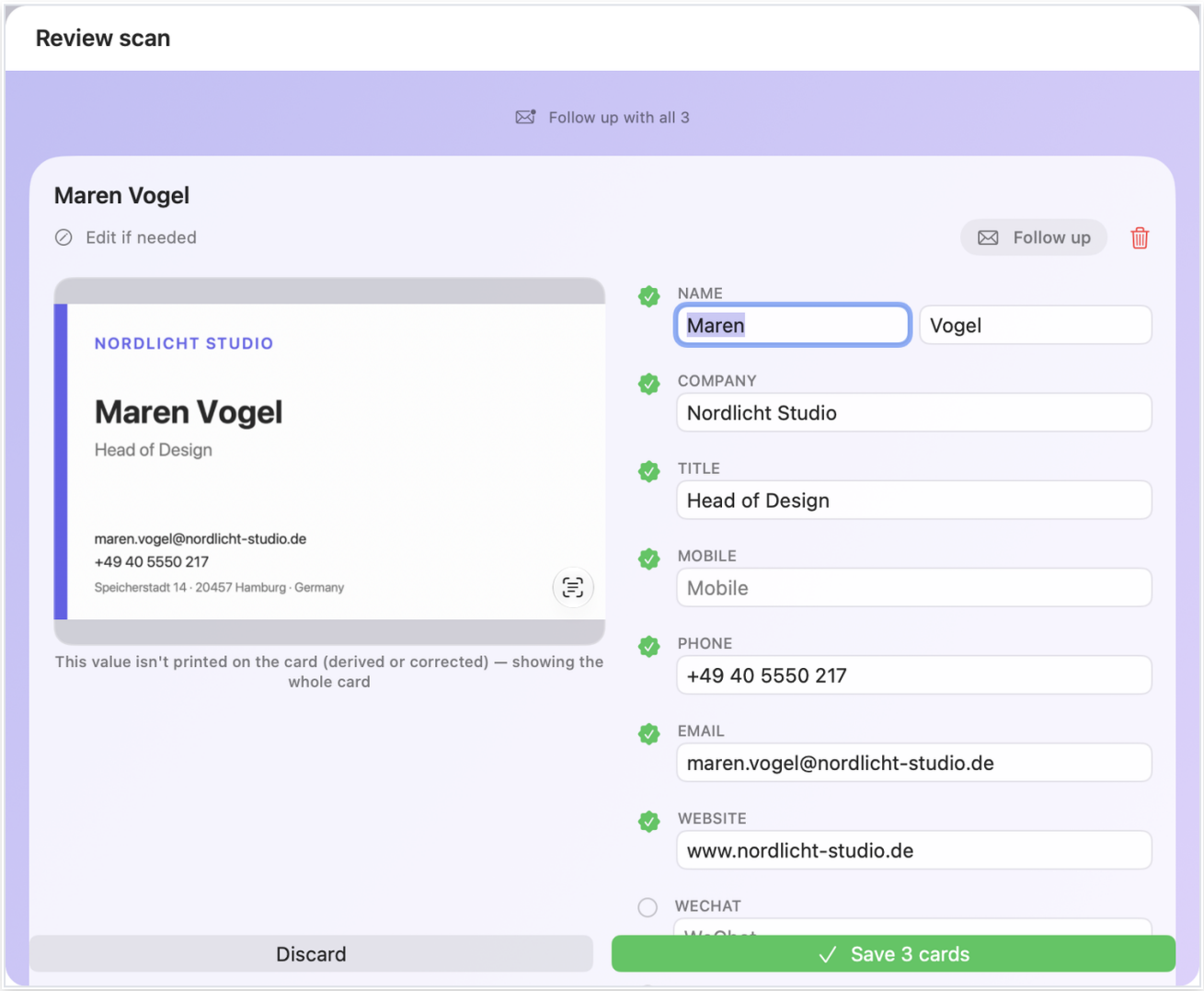
Photos, Share sheet & Paste

- **Photos** — import one or more card images from your library.
- **Share sheet** — share a card image (or a copied email signature) from any app straight into cardlio. A photo of several cards is detected and handed to the full scanner — every card lands in the review screen.

- **Paste a signature** — paste the text of an email signature and cardlio builds a card from it, no photo needed.
- **Services menu (Mac)** — in Mail, Outlook or any app, select an email signature and choose **Services → Send Signature to cardlio** (right-click the selection, or the app menu → Services): the Paste Signature sheet opens with it. Select a name or an email address and choose **Services → Find in cardlio** to jump to that person in your library — an email address anywhere in the selection is what it searches for. Either can get a keyboard shortcut in **System Settings → Keyboard → Keyboard Shortcuts → Services**.

Reviewing & editing a scan

After a scan, cardlio shows a review screen before anything is saved. Each field carries a validity badge, and anything the parser was unsure about is easy to correct. You can drop a stray detection without discarding the rest of the batch.



The review screen. Green badges mark validated fields and every field is editable; Follow up marks a person you owe an email, and the button at the bottom saves the whole batch at once.

- Tap any field to edit it — the card preview **zooms to the exact spot** that value was read from and outlines it, so checking a shaky value never means squinting. On iPhone, a snippet of that spot also appears right above the field you're editing.
- The preview is **Live Text**: select and copy a line straight off the photo if the scan missed it.
- A small **sparkle** next to Name, Company, or Title means on-device AI is still polishing that field in the background. The instant you edit a field it's yours — AI never overwrites your edits.
- Hard-to-read card and a cloud AI key configured? That card offers a one-tap **refine with Claude or Gemini** that re-reads the photo with your chosen provider — one card, one tap, one request.
- The **address** — street, postal code, city, country — is editable right in the review, with a badge showing whether Apple Maps verified it.
- A green check means the value looks valid (e.g. a well-formed email or phone); a yellow question mark means the text engine wasn't confident — worth a glance.
- Cards with **more than one email address** show each in its own row — Email, Email 2, and so on. Clear a row and it's dropped on save.
- **VAT number** — a company VAT or tax number on the card (P.IVA, USt-IdNr., TVA, BTW, VAT No. …) gets its own field, stored with its country prefix (IT01234567890) and kept out of the phone fields. For EU numbers, **Check in VIES** under the field asks the EU Commission's VAT service whether the number is valid and, where the country shares it, shows the registered name and address — only when you tap it, and only the number is sent. A personal Italian Codice Fiscale goes to the notes instead. The number is in the CSV export and the webhook.
- **WeChat and LinkedIn** are captured when the card prints them — a "WeChat: …" line or a linkedin.com address — into their own fields, so a WeChat ID never lands in a phone field. They travel with the contact into vCards, CSV exports, Apple Contacts (LinkedIn as a social profile, WeChat as an instant-message address), and Office 365.
- Use ⋯ → **Remove from Batch** on a card (Mac: the trash icon) to remove just that one; **Discard** always asks first.

On the free tier, a scan that would pass the card limit is never thrown away: the review sheet warns up front, keeps your reviewed cards and edits, and lets you unlock and save them on the spot.

The cards that need you come first

A conference batch might be forty cards of which three were misread. Rather than make you scroll the stack, the review screen puts the cards that need a human at the **top** — most problems first, with a coloured line down their edge and a note saying "3 of 40 need a look". Everything below is fine and can be saved without ever being opened.

Fixing a field does **not** make the card jump somewhere else. The order is set when the screen opens and only changes when the batch itself does — a card removed, retaken, or merged — so nothing slides away under your finger while you type.

Prefer to work through the **physical stack** in your hand? Turn off **Show cards that need a look first** in **Settings → Review** (Mac: Settings → General). The review screen then keeps the cards in exactly the order you scanned them, so the card on screen is always the next one in the pile.

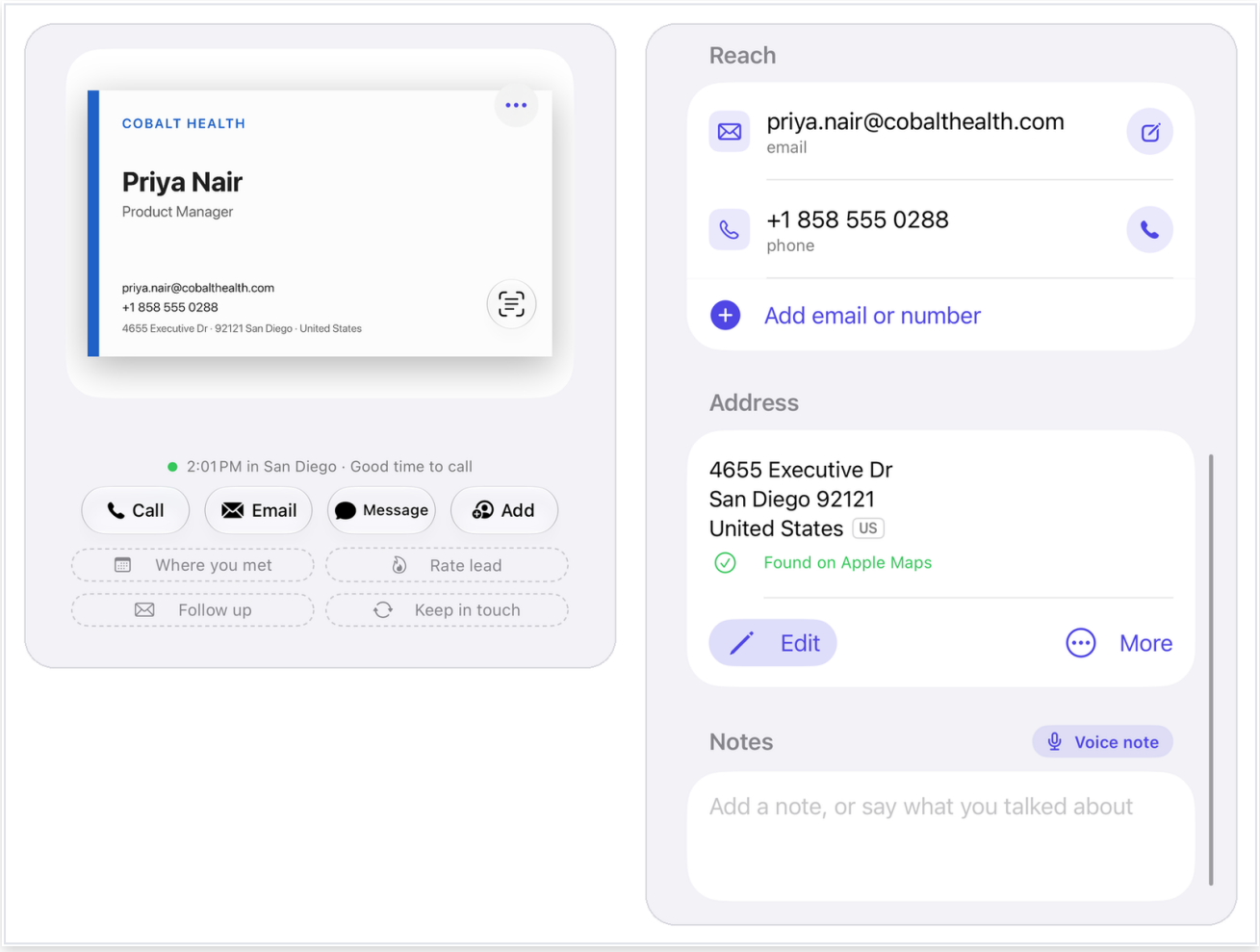
When cardlio can suggest the fix

Sometimes the app already knows the likely right answer. If an email was mangled but the website came through, or a phone number is missing its country code, a small **suggestion appears under the field** — tap it to accept, ignore it to keep what's there. Nothing is ever changed for you, and a suggestion only appears when it differs from what was read.

A saved card's editor

Open a card from the library and its editor reads like a contact sheet:

- **The photo** — on iPhone, the ⋯ button on its corner rotates it, opens crop & adjust, and shows the text cardlio read from it (Mac: press Space for the photo workbench). **Refine** in the top bar reads the card again with the cloud AI chosen in Settings — long-press it (Mac: hover) to see which. On iPhone a card's page uses the whole screen; **Back** returns to the tabs.
- **At the top**, chips for where you met, the lead rating, the follow-up and keep in touch. An unset chip is dashed; tap (Mac: click) one to set it, and once set it states its value — "Hot lead", "Follow-up owed".
- **Reach** — one row per email or number, with its kind underneath, edited right in place. The round button beside it calls or writes. On iPhone, swipe a row left to remove it and add one with **Add email or number**; on Mac, hover a row for write, copy and remove, and use **+ Add**.
- **Address** — reads like an envelope, in the order that country writes it ("San Diego 92121", "0250 Oslo"), beside a small map that opens Apple Maps. The line above Call and Email gives the local time there; the address says whether Apple Maps found it. **Edit** gives the fields with **Cancel** and **Done**; Done checks a changed address on Apple Maps straight away. The ⋯ menu holds check again, read the address text again, open in Maps and remove from map.
- **Notes** — the **Voice note** button records context and adds it to the note.
- **Honorific** (Dr., Capt.) shows when the card has one; **Add Honorific** under Title puts one on a card that doesn't.



A saved card on iPhone: the photo with its ··· menu, the local time, Call · Email · Message · Add, the chips, one row per email or number, and the address the way an envelope reads, with Edit and More beneath it. The Mac editor has the same sections.

Reading a card in another language

When a card's title, company, or address is printed in a script you don't read — Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Cyrillic — the card editor shows a **Translation** section with a **Translate** button. Tap it and the English (or whichever language your device is set to) appears underneath each line: 销售总监 becomes "Sales Director", 株式会社山田製作所 becomes "Yamada Manufacturing Co., Ltd.", and a Japanese address comes back re-ordered into the Western street-first form.

Translation runs **entirely on your device** — the same technology as Translate on iPhone — so a foreign card is readable on a plane with no signal, and nothing is sent anywhere to do it. The card itself is never changed: it keeps exactly what was printed on it, and the translation sits beneath it. The translation **is kept with the card**, so it is still there when you come back to it, it travels to your other devices, it rides along in an exported vCard, and you can search a card by it — typing "Yusen Building" finds the card that prints 郵船ビル. Cards written in the Latin alphabet show no Translate button, because there is nothing to translate.

Names are never translated. A translator will happily turn 山田 太郎 into a lowercase "taro yamada" or invent an English first name that was never on the card, so cardlio keeps names exactly as printed and instead makes them **searchable in the Latin alphabet** — typing "shiquan" finds 黎士銓, in the app and in system Search.

- **E-mail addresses are checked.** The review sheet looks up the domain of the e-mail address. A domain that doesn't exist — usually one misread letter — is flagged, and when one letter swap gives a domain that does exist, that address is offered as a one-tap fix. Only the domain name leaves your device, to the same resolver every app uses.

Following up

The point of a card is usually the email you owe afterwards. cardlio keeps that as a simple list you build yourself — it never guesses who mattered.

Mark them while you remember

In the review screen, each card has a **Follow up** button. Tap it for the people you owe a follow-up. That moment — right after the conversation — is the only time you reliably remember which of forty cards mattered, and marking is one tap for the ones that did and nothing at all for the rest. Scanning a whole event you intend to write to? **Follow up with all** marks the batch at once, and the same button clears them again.

Find them again

- Cards you owe carry a small coloured **dot** in the list.
- Above the list, **"9 to follow up"** appears whenever there are any — tap it to see just those people. It's an ordinary search filter, so you can combine it with an event or a company.
- On the card itself, the **Follow-up owed** chip at the top of its editor: tap it for "Met at GITEX · 3 days ago · not yet followed up" and **Mark done** when you've written.

Hand it to your own to-do list

Add to Reminders puts the follow-up in the Reminders app, due tomorrow morning, with the person, the company and where you met already written in. Change the time there — that's rather the point of handing it over. cardlio adds the reminder and then forgets about it: it doesn't read your reminders, and ticking one off in Reminders doesn't change anything here (or the other way round). Two lists, one hand-off, no surprises.

cardlio can't read your mailbox, and doesn't try. It never claims an email was sent — the note simply says a follow-up hasn't been marked done yet, and you clear it when you have. If you change your mind later, **Owe again** puts the person back on the list.

Marks sync across your devices like any other field, so a card you flag on the phone at a conference is waiting for you on the Mac.

Leads & keeping in touch

Two things only you know about a person: whether they were a real lead, and whether they are worth staying in touch with. cardlio lets you say both — and never guesses either.

Rate the lead

In the review screen, under each card's fields, choose **Hot**, **Warm** or **Cold**. Tap once to set it, tap the same one again to clear it. Unrated is the default, so the people who were not leads cost you nothing. You can change it later with the lead chip at the top of the card's editor (it reads **Rate lead**, or the rating once set).

Scanning in **Event mode**, the rating moves to the **top** of each review card, above the fields, so you can rate each person while the conversation is still fresh — the fields can wait.

- **Interests** — add your own labels in **Settings**, under **Lead interests** (on the Mac, Settings → Tags): "Demo requested", "Pricing", "Agency". They appear as chips beside the rating; tap the ones this person asked about. Until you add labels, no chips appear.
- Rated cards carry a small flame, sun or snowflake in the list. Type **hot** — or one of your labels — in search to filter; combined with an event it reads "the hot leads from the fair".
- **Ask your network** understands them too: "hot leads from Posidonia", "who asked for a demo?"

Where the rating goes

- **Salesforce CSV** — into Salesforce's own **Rating** column, which takes exactly Hot, Warm and Cold; the interests and the event go into the Description.
- **Outlook CSV** — as **Categories** ("Hot lead; Pricing"), which Outlook can filter on.
- The **generic CSV**, the **CRM webhook** and a **team library** carry both.
- **Not** into vCards or your synced contacts. A vCard is also how you pass a contact to someone else, and what you thought of a person should not travel with it.

Keep in touch

In the card's editor, the **Keep in touch** chip sets a rhythm for that person: every 3 months, every 6 months, or every year.

- The clock runs from the last time you were in touch — **I was in touch today**, or a follow-up you marked done; both count. Until then it runs from the day you met.
- Above the list, **"4 to reconnect"** appears whenever somebody is due — tap it to see just those people. Like the follow-up list, it is an ordinary filter.
- **Draft** writes a short check-in email on your device with Apple Intelligence, from what the card and your notes say. It never invents news or plans.
- **Repeat in Reminders** adds one repeating reminder to the Reminders app. As with follow-ups, cardlio hands it over and forgets it.

No stages, no scores, no notifications: one rating and one rhythm per person. Both sync to your other devices and are kept in backups.

Double-sided cards

Many cards carry information on both sides — the address on the back, or a full second language (a Japanese front with an English back is the norm in Japan). cardlio keeps both sides in **one contact**, with both photos.

- **Add the back while reviewing** (iPhone / iPad) — tap ··· → **Scan the Back** on the card, flip the physical card over, and scan its other side. The back's fields merge into the same card: the address fills in, extra phone numbers and emails are added, and a name printed in another script lands in the **alternate-name** fields — so 山田太郎 and "Taro Yamada" are one person, findable by either name.
- **Scanned both sides as two captures?** cardlio notices when two cards in one batch look like the two sides of one card — the same email or mobile number on both, or one side reading as the translation or the address side of the other — and offers **Merge as sides** right above them. One tap collapses the pair into a single double-sided card.
- When a pair is confirmed by a shared email or mobile number, the banner also offers **Always merge automatically**. Opted in, such pairs merge on arrival — always with an **Undo** that restores the two separate scans.
- **The flip button** — wherever the card photo appears (the review screen, the card editor, the Mac's Space preview), a double-sided card shows a flip control. The back is Live Text too, and rotate / Edit photo act on whichever side is on screen.
- **Add a back to a saved card** (Mac) — right-click its tile → **Add Card Back…** and choose the photo.
- A back that clearly names a **different person** is refused rather than blended — shared cards stay two cards. And a translated company name is preserved in Notes, so searching either language finds the contact.
- **Refine reads both sides.** The Refine button sends the front and the back to Claude, Gemini or Apple's model, so an address printed only on the back is read too. The built-in reader also knows building names like "One JLT" and district names like "Jumeirah Lakes Towers", and files a P.O. Box in Notes, where it belongs.

Screenshots of signatures, chats and profiles

A screenshot has no card in it, so cardlio reads **the whole screen** and keeps the block that carries a contact: name, title, company, phones, e-mail, address. The subject line, the chat bubbles around it and the rest of the screen are left out. Share the screenshot to cardlio from Photos, or import it in the app; on the Mac, drag it onto the window.

- **Where it earns its keep:** an e-mail signature seen in another app, a contact someone pasted into a group chat, a conference app's attendee page, a card photographed and sent to you as an image.
- **Small grey type and links.** On iPhone the system's careful text reader sometimes does not see small grey text or underlined links at all. cardlio notices the gap, finds those lines with the fast reader and re-reads each one close up. A line that can only be read the quick way is marked for a check in the review sheet rather than trusted silently.
- **Nothing leaves your device** for any of this — it is the same on-device recognition the camera uses.

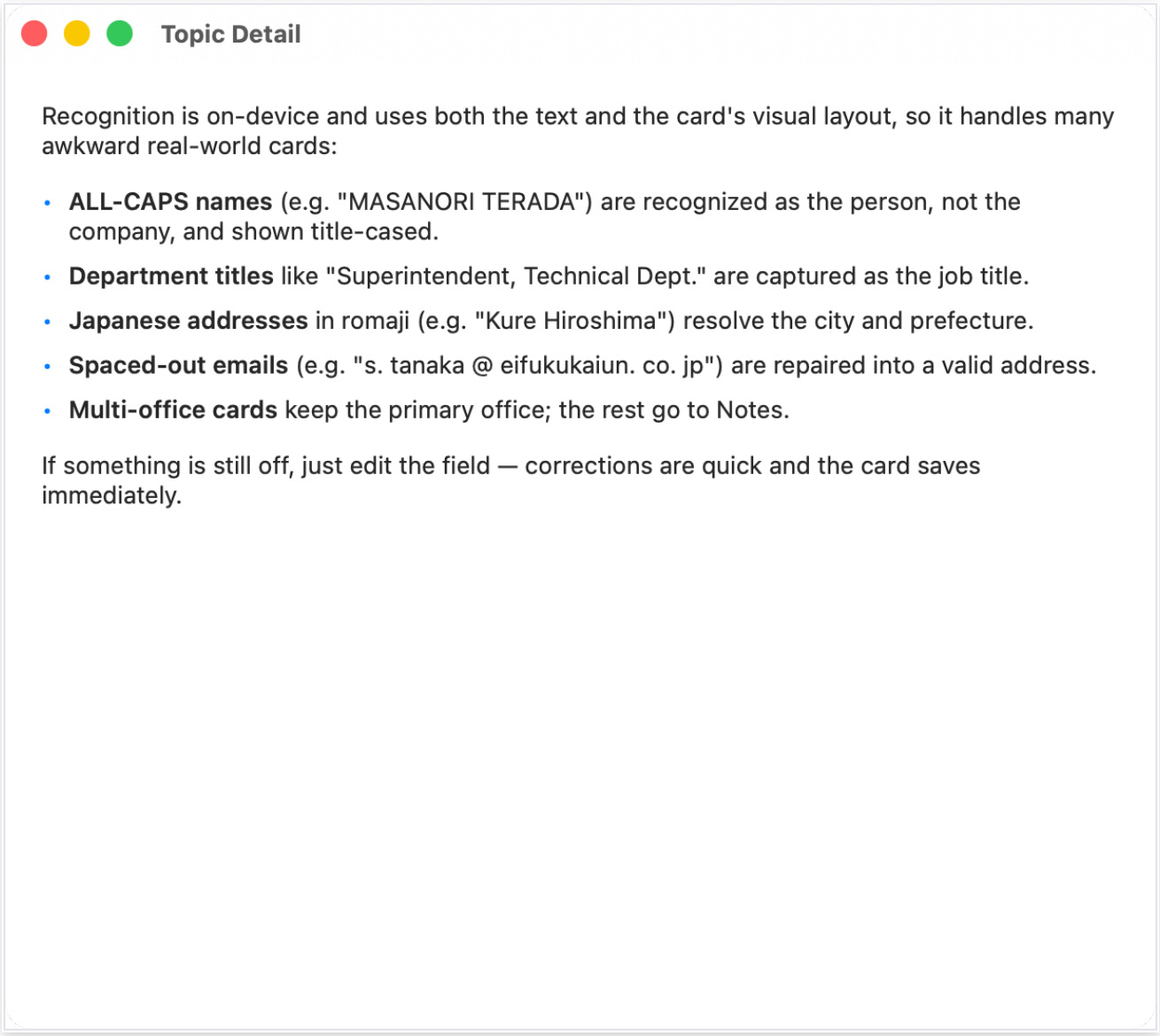
QR codes and NFC cards you receive

A card that carries the contact inside its **QR code** (a vCard or MeCard) is read on the spot — those fields win over the printed text. More and more cards instead carry a code that opens a **hosted contact page** — the "vCard Plus" pages from QR generators and digital-card apps. cardlio recognises those and treats them differently:

- The page link **never becomes the website** — the printed domain stays in that field.
- The review sheet **offers to fetch** the contact details from the page. One tap, and only when you say so, because the visit reaches the card owner's provider and they may see it.
- **Tap an NFC business card** (iPhone) — **More → Tap NFC Card…** reads a Popl, Linq, Mobilo or cardlio tag. A tag that carries the contact is added on the spot; a tag that links to a contact page is offered first, exactly like a QR link.
- Two cardlio users need no network at all: a cardlio link is the card, and cardlio decodes it on your device — QR or tag.
- **A QR code the photo couldn't read.** A dense QR — the kind that carries a whole contact card — needs more detail than a photo of the whole card sometimes gives. cardlio notices a QR code it could not decode and says so in the review sheet. On **iPhone**, tap **Scan QR Code** and hold the phone close to just the code: the scanner keeps focusing until it has it, and the details are added to the card like any QR read (fields you already edited stay yours). On the Mac, a closer photo usually reads it.

How recognition works

Recognition combines the card's **text** with its **visual layout** — the largest text near the top is treated as the name, keyword and language cues separate title from company, and the on-device text engine pre-detects emails, phones, and addresses. That layered approach handles many awkward real-world cards:



The in-app explanation of the recognition edge cases cardlio handles automatically.

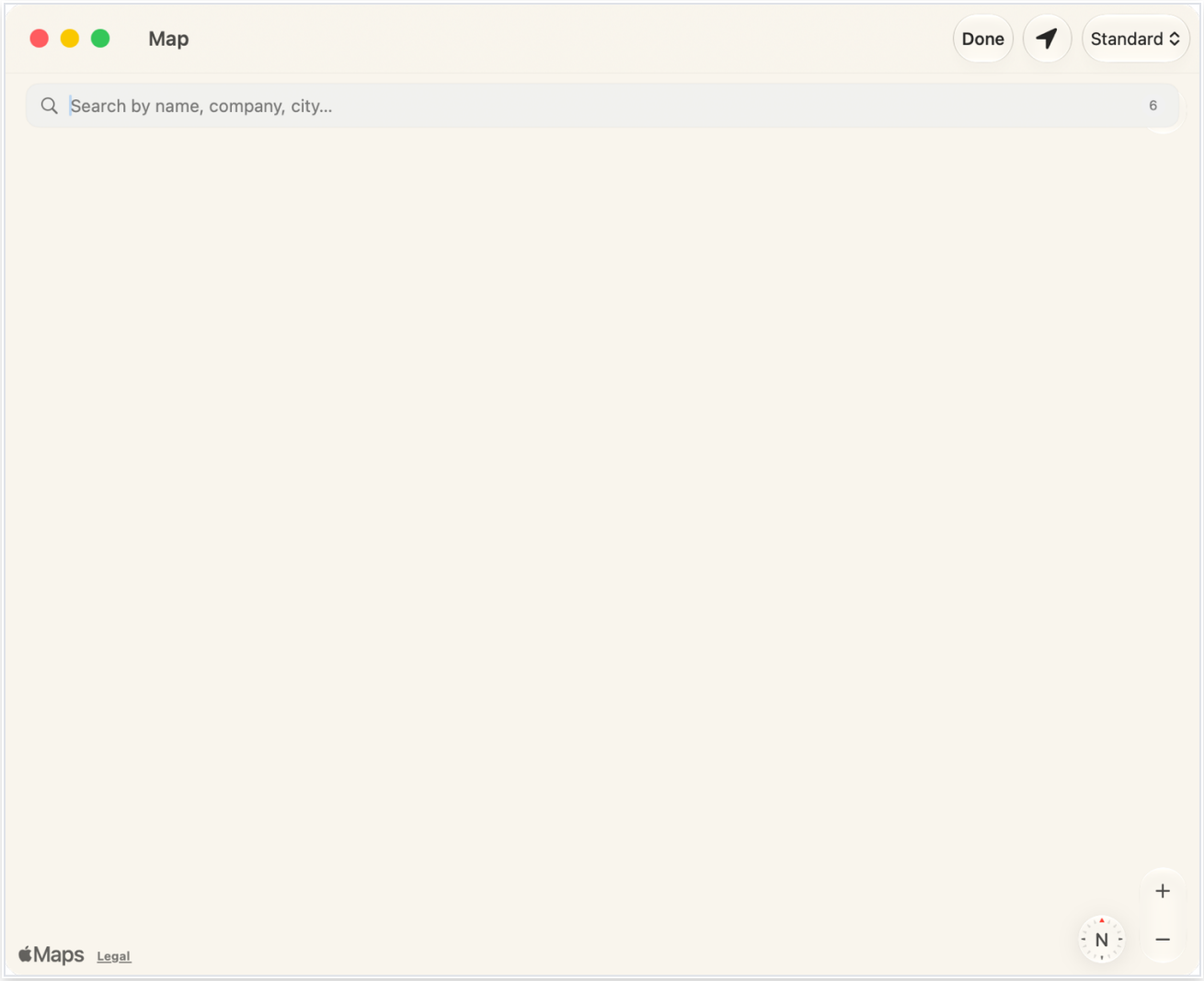
- **ALL-CAPS names** are recognized as the person, not the company, and shown title-cased.
- **Department titles** like "Superintendent, Technical Dept." are captured as the job title.
- **International addresses** are read across country formats — city, postal code, and country land in the right fields.
- **Spaced-out emails** ("j. smith @ example. com") are repaired into a valid address.
- **Multi-office cards** keep the person's office in the address fields and put every other office in Notes, under "Other locations" — whether the card heads each office on a line of its own ("Head Office", "Tokyo Office"), labels it inside the address ("Shanghai office:", "Add1:", "Malaysia:"), or prints a P.O. box beside the office address. Usually that is the first office printed; when all of the person's numbers dial one country, the office in that country wins.

- **28 languages** — the text of a card is read in English, French, German, Italian, Spanish, Portuguese, Dutch, Danish, Norwegian, Swedish, Finnish, Polish, Czech, Romanian, Turkish, Russian, Ukrainian, Chinese (Simplified and Traditional), Cantonese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Thai, Indonesian, Malay, Arabic, Hindi and Marathi, all on your device; a card that mixes two of them is fine. Sorting the text into name, company and address works best on cards in Latin script, Chinese, Japanese and Korean — on Arabic, Thai and Hindi cards the text is read, but check the fields more closely. Handwritten notes are recognised in Latin script.

If anything is still off, just edit the field — corrections are quick and the card saves immediately.

Addresses & the map

Every address is checked against **Apple Maps** to normalize the city, postal code, and country, and to drop a pin. Verification runs automatically on scans, imports, pasted signatures, and shared cards — no third-party service, and nothing leaves Apple's ecosystem.



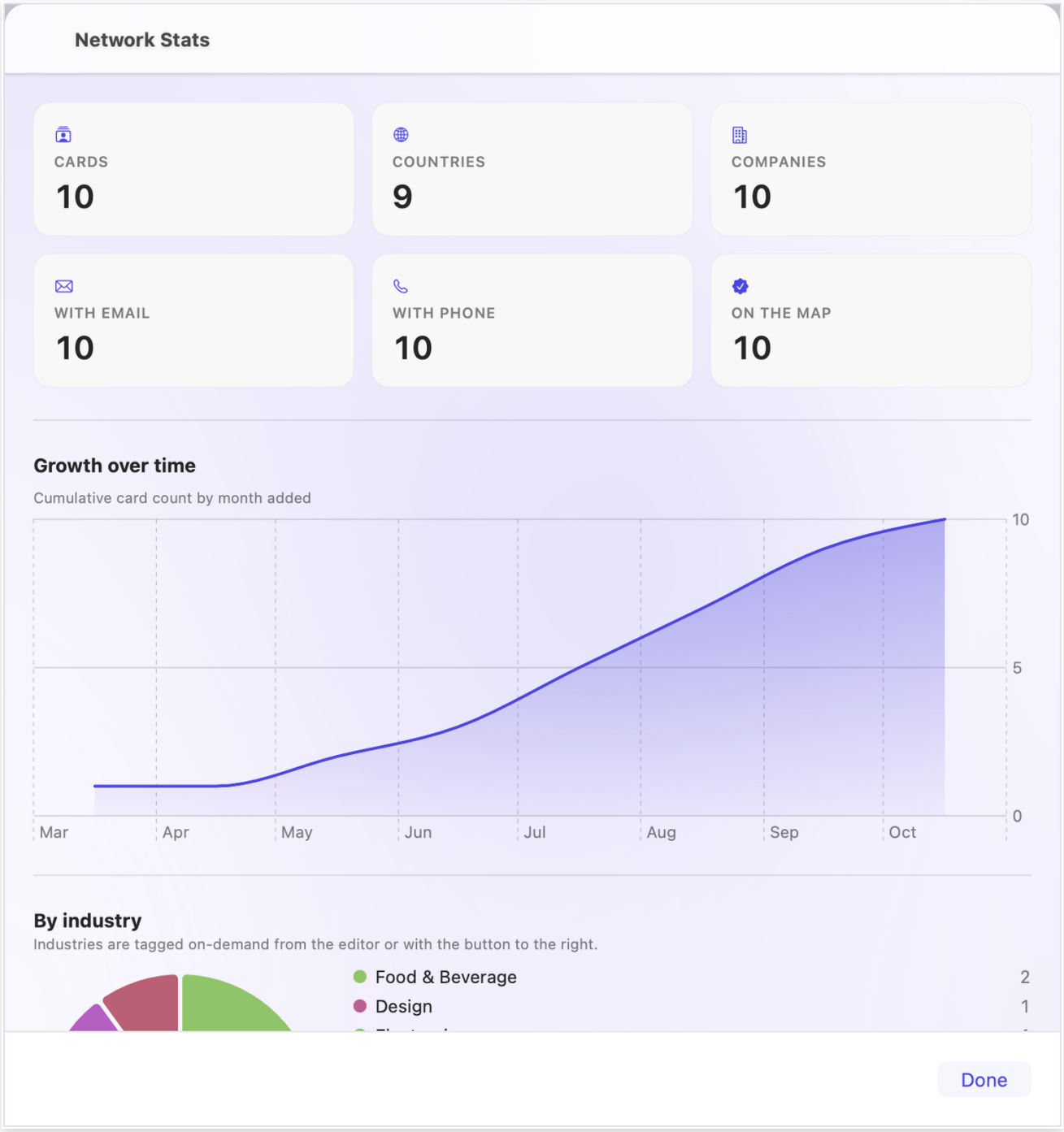
The Map screen. Search across your contacts and see them alongside your location. (Map tiles and pins require a network connection; this render was captured offline.)

- Nearby pins collapse into a **count badge**; tap it to zoom in.

- When several people share the **same address** — colleagues at one company, say — tapping the badge lists their cards, and each row opens the card with directions one tap away.
- Tapping a pin's card takes you straight to it in your library.
- **Cards in this area** — before a trip, move the map to the city and press **Cards in this area** at the bottom. The library then shows only the people there, as a filter in the search field ("Around Oslo"), so you can export them, write to them or start a follow-up run with them. Only cards with a verified address count.
- **Get a ride there** (iPhone) — **Get a Ride**, beside **Edit** under a card's address, opens the ride app you use (Grab, Uber, Lyft, Bolt, DiDi, FreeNow, Careem and others) with the card's address as the destination and you as the pickup; **Directions** offers Google Maps and Waze. Only apps installed on your iPhone are listed. Where the app accepts it the destination is filled in; for the rest the app opens with the address already copied, ready to paste. cardlio sends nothing to these services, and you still confirm the ride in the app.
- **No single right location?** People with several offices often shouldn't have one pin. **Remove from Map**, in the ··· menu under the address in a card's editor, takes it off the map and keeps the address. Clearing all of a card's address fields takes it off the map too — for good; nothing looks the old address up again.
- Only an address with a **street, a city or a postcode** is placed on the map. A card whose address resolves to no more than a country or a state stays off it rather than landing in the middle of that country.

Network stats

The Stats screen summarizes your library at a glance: how many cards you have, how many countries and companies they span, and how completely they're filled in. A growth chart tracks cards added over time, and you can tag cards by industry.



The Stats screen with a sample library of ten cards across nine countries.

Further down, **Events and companies** shows where you met whom: your events on a ring, and around each the companies whose cards carry that event; a company you met at several events is pulled into the middle, between them. Size is people. Hover for the numbers, and click an event or a company to see its cards in the library (on iPhone, in Search). Cards need an event tag to appear — see **Events** for tagging cards after the fact.

Your own industries

The industry tag comes from a built-in list of broad sectors. If your world is more specific — "Bus", "Limousine", "Taxi", "NEMT" — add your own under **Settings → Industries** (on the Mac, the Tags tab). Type several at once, separated by commas, or open **Built-in industries** and copy the ones you keep with **+**. Each industry shows how many cards carry it, and **Rename** (swipe right on iPhone, the ⋯ menu on Mac) offers to retag those cards to the new name. Choose **Use only my industries** to replace the built-in list, or leave it off to offer yours alongside it. The tag picker, the AI classification and the Stats chart then use them, and the list syncs to your other devices. Cards already tagged keep their tag.

AI refinement

On top of the built-in parser, cardlio can optionally use AI to decide which line is the person versus the company on especially tricky cards. This is always optional — the deterministic parser handles everything on its own.

- **On-device (Apple Intelligence)** — private, offline, no key required. Available on supported devices.
- **Apple's Private Cloud Compute** (iOS 27 / macOS 27) — choose it as the provider in **Settings**, beside Claude and Gemini. It runs the Refine button, the pronunciation guide, industry tags and the automatic polish on Apple's much larger server model. No key, no account, and Apple's servers keep nothing: the request is encrypted to the machines that answer it and erased when they are done. Apple sets a daily allowance per person — Settings shows where you stand, and when the limit is reached the polish simply continues on your device until it resets. It cannot browse the web, so **Company Insights** keeps using Claude or Gemini — with Apple's selected, Settings shows a **Company Insights** row right under the provider, where you pick which of the two fetches the news (and whose key it uses).
- **Cloud (bring your own key)** — Anthropic Claude or Google Gemini for the hardest cards. Add a key under Settings.
- **Local address reader (Mac with Apple silicon and 16 GB of memory)** — an optional model you download once, about 3.1 GB, in **Settings → Local Models**. It reads the **address** on each card photo — street, building, unit, postcode, city and country — and the **company name** as printed, entirely on your Mac: no account, no key, no quota, and nothing sent anywhere. It runs in the review sheet after the polish, about two seconds a card, and never touches a field you have edited; names and title stay with the standard reading. For a card **already in your library**, click **Read with Local AI** under its address in the editor: the model reads the photo and shows what it would change, old value beside new, and only the fields you keep are saved. The same Settings tab switches the automatic pass off or deletes the model. If you downloaded it before version 3.1.3, the tab offers an improved model under **Download Update**; the earlier one keeps reading until the update has downloaded, then it is removed.

On an iPhone running iOS 27 with Apple Intelligence on, cardlio asks **once** whether to use Private Cloud Compute, in a short sheet that explains what it does before anything is switched on. **Turn On** makes it your provider; **Not Now** leaves everything on-device. Either answer — including swiping the sheet away — uses up the one time, so you are never asked again; you can change your mind whenever you like under Settings → the provider picker. The question waits until nothing else is in front of you, and never appears mid-scan or over a review.

Both appear in the review sheet: the on-device pass polishes name, title, and company automatically while you review (the sparkle next to a field), and when the OCR was shaky a one-tap cloud refine is offered right on that card. Cloud AI can also be run any time from a saved card's editor.

Cloud AI is opt-in. Your API key is stored in the Keychain and is only ever sent to the provider you choose. With no key and no Apple Intelligence, nothing is sent anywhere.

Who is this?

The newspaper button on a card opens **Insights**. Nothing is sent when it opens: **Research** followed by the company's name fetches the company news, and above it **Look up** followed by the person's name searches the web for the person, with your Claude or Gemini key. You get whether it found them — **Likely the same person**, **Possible match** or **Couldn't find them**, with the reason — their current role, a short background, and their LinkedIn profile. If they have moved on since the card was printed, it says so: "The card says NYK Line — this now says …".

- It runs **only when you tap it**, and sends the name, company, job title, website and city — never the email address or phone numbers.
- Nothing is saved unless you tap **Add LinkedIn to card** or **Add to notes**. Replacing a LinkedIn link the card already has asks first.
- A LinkedIn link is only ever one the web search actually returned — cardlio checks, rather than trusting the model not to make one up. With no page it can show, a "likely" is downgraded to "possible".

With Apple Intelligence available, a card's editor also offers **Draft Follow-up** (the compose button at the top of a card on iPhone; right-click a card on Mac): the on-device model turns the card's details and your voice-note context into a ready-to-edit follow-up email — pick a tone (Professional, Warm, Brief), tweak the text, and open it in Mail or copy it. The draft never references anything that isn't on the card or in your notes, and nothing is generated or sent through any server.

Exports — Contacts, CSV & Salesforce

Export a single card or your entire library. On Mac, use the Export menu in the toolbar; on iPhone and iPad, the Export button opens the share sheet.

- **vCard (.vcf)** — imports into Apple Contacts, Outlook, Google Contacts, and most other address books.

- **Generic CSV** — every field, for spreadsheets.
- **Outlook CSV** — the column names Outlook's import expects.
- **Salesforce CSV** — headers that auto-map in Salesforce's Data Import Wizard; records import as **Leads**, with your lead **Rating**.

All CSV exports are hardened against spreadsheet formula injection, so a value that begins with =, +, or @ can't execute when the file is opened — and phone numbers stay clean when the file is imported into Outlook or Salesforce.

Keeping the library current

People change jobs and companies close; a card stays as it was printed. Two checks on the Mac (**File → Library**) find the cards that have gone out of date:

- **Check Email Domains…** — looks up every company email domain in your library (free-mail addresses are left out) and lists the domains that no longer exist, with their cards. A domain that has gone usually means the company closed, merged or renamed itself, so the person on that card has probably moved on. Only the domain names are looked up, through your Mac's normal internet name lookup; nothing else leaves the Mac. If the Mac seems to be offline, the check says so instead of flagging everything. Some domains were simply misread when the card was scanned — "nordvikmarine.corn" for "nordvikmarine.com". Where one letter swapped the way scanning misreads letters gives a domain that exists, the check lists it under **Probably misread** with the correction; **Fix** (or **Fix All**) corrects the email address, and the website if it is the same domain, on those cards.
- **Match LinkedIn Connections…** — download your connections from LinkedIn in a web browser on a computer: click your photo (**Me**) → **Settings & Privacy** → **Data privacy** → **Download your data** (or go straight to linkedin.com/mypreferences/d/download-my-data), choose **Download larger data archive, including connections…** (connections are not in the pick-your-own list), then **Request archive**. LinkedIn emails a download link when the archive is ready, which can take up to a day; the .zip holds many files, among them **Connections.csv**. Open that file here. Only 1st-degree connections are included, and LinkedIn leaves out most email addresses, so cardlio also matches by name. cardlio matches the connections to your cards — by email address where LinkedIn includes one, otherwise by name, in either order — and shows who is **at another company now**: **Update Card** takes the company and position from LinkedIn and keeps the old ones in a dated note, **Add a Note Only** leaves the card as printed. It also lists the cards that can take their **LinkedIn link**, one by one or all at once. Two cards with the same name and no matching company are left alone rather than guessed. Only your file is read; nothing is sent to LinkedIn.

Coming from another app

Moving from another card scanner, or from a spreadsheet of contacts? **Import from Another App…** — on the Mac under **File → Library**, on iPhone and iPad in the More menu under **Library** — reads the file the other app exported and shows a preview before anything is added: what kind of file it is, how many contacts, the first few, which columns were read and which were left out, and how many are already in your library.

- **vCard (.vcf)** — what CamCard, ABBYY Business Card Reader and WorldCard can export, what Microsoft Lens attached to each OneNote page (Lens was retired in 2026; save the attachments, or export the contacts from Outlook), and what Apple Contacts, Outlook and Google Contacts write. Old vCard 2.1 files with accented characters, and contact photos, are read too.
- **CSV** — Outlook and Google Contacts exports are recognised exactly. Any other app's CSV — Covve Scan's "Export all cards", a CRM's export, your own spreadsheet — is matched by the names of its columns: Name, First Name, Company, Position, Mobile, Email, Address and their many variants. Comma, semicolon and tab files work, in UTF-8, UTF-16, Windows or Japanese and Chinese encodings.
- **Excel (.xlsx)** — CamCard's Excel export, including its Japanese column names (名前, 社名, 役職, 携帯番号 …).
- Contacts already in your library — the same email, or the same name at the same company — are skipped, so importing the same file twice adds nothing.

Phone numbers are turned into international format and a one-line address is split into street, city and postcode, as for a scanned card. Imported cards have no card photo, because no app exports one; a contact picture in a vCard is kept. On the free version, cards beyond the free limit wait for cardlio Premium rather than being dropped.

Backing up your library

Exports hand your cards to another program. A **backup** is different: it's a complete copy of your library that cardlio itself can read back — photos, both sides, every field, and a vCard per contact — in one **.zip** you can keep anywhere.

- **Make one** — Mac: **File → Library → Back Up Library…**; iPhone / iPad: the More menu → **Library → Back Up Library…**. You choose where it goes: iCloud Drive, a USB stick, your Mac's Documents folder.
- **What's inside** — a `cards.json` with every field (follow-up marks, lead ratings, keep-in-touch and saved translations included), both card images for each contact, a `.vcf` per contact, and a README. Open formats on purpose: even without cardlio, the photos are photos and the contacts are vCards. Nothing is locked in.
- **Restore** — same menu → **Restore from Backup…**, then pick the zip. Restoring is **additive and repeatable**: cards already in your library are recognized and skipped rather than duplicated, so restoring the same backup twice changes nothing.
- **On the free tier** a restore fills up to the free card limit and tells you plainly how many were left out, so a backup never silently loses cards.

Backups are your insurance against the situations iCloud can't help with — a mistaken delete that syncs everywhere, or simply wanting a copy that isn't tied to any account. Making one before a big clean-up is never wasted effort.

Office 365 & Contacts sync

Beyond files, cardlio can put your cards straight into your contacts — either your Microsoft **Office 365** mailbox or your local **Apple Contacts**.

Sync to Office 365 (Outlook)

Connect your Microsoft account once — on **Mac** under Settings → Office 365, on **iPhone and iPad** in Settings — then choose **Sync to Office 365** from the Export menu. The sync is one-way, from cardlio into your Office 365 contacts.

- Run it any time: new cards are **added**, edited cards are **updated**, and deleted cards are **removed**.
- Each contact is linked to its card by a hidden identifier, so repeat syncs **never create duplicates** — even after a reinstall or on a new Mac.
- Fields map to Outlook's own, including **Business Fax** and the full postal address.
- Contacts go **only to your own Microsoft account** — nothing passes through a server we run.

Save to Contacts (Apple Contacts)

Prefer your cards in iCloud or On My Mac? On the Mac, **Save to Contacts** writes them into the Apple Contacts account you choose; on iPhone and iPad, the **Add** button on a card opens the system contact editor so you review and pick the account.

- If your Office 365 account is connected, use the sync above for Outlook rather than pointing Save to Contacts at an Exchange account — aiming both at the same mailbox can create duplicates. The account picker reminds you.
- Card images aren't attached to contacts, so your address book stays light on every device.

Team library

At a fair you are rarely scanning alone. A **team library** is a shared pile of cards for one event or project: everyone on the team can add to it, and anyone can take a card into their own library. It is part of the one unlock, on both platforms — the **Team** button in the Mac toolbar, and **More → Team Library…** on iPhone and iPad (with a **Team** button on the event chip while Event mode is on, which is the moment it is usually wanted).

- **Create a team** for the fair, then **invite people by the email address or phone number of their Apple Account** — an invite link on its own opens nothing, so a forwarded link cannot let a stranger in.

- **Nothing is ever shared automatically.** Event mode tags your scans; a card reaches the team only when you deliberately send it — select cards and use **Share with Team** (right-click in the Mac gallery, or Select Multiple on iPhone).
- **Claiming** a team card copies it into your own library, and the team sees that it has been claimed — so two people do not chase the same lead. Tap a card first to read it in full: photo, every field, who contributed it, and the lead rating they gave it. **Add all … unclaimed** takes every open card in one go.
- A card a colleague already claimed can still be yours to keep: **Add Copy** puts it in your library without changing who is working the lead.
- **Team notes** on a card — "called 19 Sep, send the brochure" — are shared with everyone on the team, and anyone on it can edit them. The card's own notes stay as they were scanned.
- Colleagues keep adding cards during the day: pull the list down, or press **Refresh**, to see the latest — the sheet does not poll on its own.
- The sheet says whether a team is yours or one you joined, how many cards it holds, how many are still unclaimed, and how many people are on it.
- Shared cards carry a **smaller photo** than your original, so a team stays light on everyone's iCloud. Your own capture never leaves your library.
- Only the person who created a team can **delete** it, and deleting shuts the door for everyone. Cards already claimed stay in the libraries that claimed them.

Team sharing runs on **your own iCloud**, the same way your library does: the cards live in a shared area of the team owner's iCloud, and there is still no server we operate.

Your team in a browser

Not everyone on a stand carries an iPhone or a Mac. **team.cardlio.app** opens the team library in any browser, on any computer: sign in with the Apple Account the invite went to, and the teams you made or joined are there.

- **Join from the browser** — in the people sheet, **Copy Web Link** gives a link that opens the team at team.cardlio.app; or paste the ordinary invite link under **Join a team** there. The person still has to be on the team's list first.
- **Everything a team member needs** — search the whole haul, filter by unclaimed or by event, open a card with its photo and every field, **claim** it, and download it or the whole list as **vCard** or **CSV**.
- The page talks only to Apple's iCloud, after Apple's own sign-in. In a team it can join, claim, add, edit and delete cards the way a team member can in the app. Your own library is there too — see **Your cards in a browser**.

Ask your network

Search finds a word you remember. **Ask** finds a person you can only describe — "who did I meet in Singapore who works in shipping?", "do I know anyone at a logistics company in Rotterdam?" It is the **Ask** button in the Mac toolbar, and the top of the Search tab on iPhone and iPad.

The answer is a sentence, and underneath it **every card that answer relies on**, ready to open. That list is the part to trust: cardlio never asks the model to find the card. The model only decides what to search for — and may look again with different words — while **your own device does the searching**, and the answer may name only cards that search actually returned. An invented colleague would have no card to attach to, so it cannot appear.

- It searches names, titles, companies, cities, countries, industries, event tags, lead ratings and interests, and your **notes** — what you jot down about someone stays findable.
- When nothing matches, it tells you **how it read the question**, so you can see which word to change.
- **Meaning search (optional).** Download it once, about 305 MB — on the Mac in **Settings → Local Models**, on iPhone and iPad in **Settings → Meaning Search** (over Wi-Fi, unless you allow mobile data there) — and Ask also finds cards by what the question means rather than only by its words: "banks or investment firms" finds a card tagged Finance, "the person who fixes ships" finds a chartering manager. The model is Google's EmbeddingGemma 2 and runs entirely on your device — your cards and questions are never sent anywhere. The first time you open Ask afterwards it prepares your cards, which takes under a minute; new and edited cards are added as you go. Switch it off or delete it in the same place, and Ask goes back to word search.
- Requires **Apple Intelligence** (iOS 27 or macOS 27) — on an older system the Ask button is not shown.
- **Who writes the answer.** With **Apple Private Cloud Compute** as your provider, Apple's larger model writes it, and the answer says “Answered by Apple's Private Cloud Compute from your cards”. It is sent your question and the few cards the search found — never your whole library — and Apple keeps none of it. With any other provider, or when Private Cloud Compute is unavailable, the answer is written on your device, and works offline.
- **Included, not a paid extra.** Asking is free and unlimited, however large your library gets.

Google Contacts sync

Push your library into your own **Google Contacts** — the same one-way sync as Office 365, for a Google account instead of a Microsoft one. Connect the account first (**Settings → Google** on Mac, **Settings** on iPhone and iPad), then use **Sync to Google Contacts** in the Export menu.

- Run it whenever you like: new cards are added, edited cards updated, and cards you delete are removed from Google too.
- Each contact carries a hidden cardlio identifier, so running the sync again updates the same contact instead of creating a second one — even after reinstalling on a new machine.
- You get a short summary afterwards — "3 added, 1 updated" — so an actual sync is distinguishable from an already-up-to-date one.

What it does not touch. cardlio reads back only the contacts it created itself, to recognise them; it never reads, stores or analyses the rest of your Google Contacts. Deletion is limited the same way, so a contact you made yourself cannot be removed by a sync however you tidy your cards. Disconnecting the account changes nothing in Google: cardlio forgets the sign-in and stops syncing, and the contacts already there stay exactly as they are.

Cards travel from your device straight to Google under your own account — no server of ours is in the path. If you delete a synced contact in Google and sync again, cardlio puts it back, on the assumption that you still want your cards there.

One honest limit: a contact is only as complete as the card behind it. Cards scanned by earlier versions sometimes never had a street extracted, and those sync across with that line missing. Re-scanning fills it in, and so does editing the card by hand — the next sync carries the correction to Google.

Send cards to your CRM

cardlio can post every card you save to a web address you choose, as it is saved. Point that address at **Zapier** or **Make** and your cards can land in Salesforce, HubSpot, Pipedrive, Zoho, Dynamics or almost any other system — without cardlio needing to build a separate connection for each one. Point it at your own server and you can do whatever you like with them.

This is the **only feature that sends your cards to a destination you choose**, and it is off until you switch it on. There is no default and no suggested destination: the address is one you enter. (The one other automatic trip is Apple's: with Apple Private Cloud Compute as your AI provider, the polish after each scan runs on Apple's servers, which keep nothing.)

Setting it up with Zapier

- In Zapier, create a Zap and choose **Webhooks by Zapier** as the trigger, with the event **Catch Hook**. Zapier gives you a URL that looks like `https://hooks.zapier.com/hooks/catch/...` — copy it.
- In cardlio, open **Settings → CRM** on the Mac, or **Settings** on iPhone and iPad, and paste the URL into **Send new cards to a webhook**. Switch the toggle on.
- Tap **Send test**. cardlio posts a **made-up contact** — never one of yours — which is exactly what Zapier needs before it can show you the fields. Back in Zapier, continue the trigger step and it will find the test record.
- Add whatever action you want — “Create Contact” in HubSpot, “Create Lead” in Salesforce, “Add Row” in Google Sheets — and map cardlio's fields onto theirs. Turn the Zap on.
- From then on, every card you save is posted automatically. Nothing else changes: the card is still saved on your device first, and a webhook that is slow or switched off never delays a scan.

Step-by-step recipes for Zapier and Make — HubSpot, Salesforce, Pipedrive and Google Sheets — and a table of every field cardlio sends are at **cardlio.app/crm.html**.

What gets sent

One JSON object per card, with the fields you would expect — name, honorific, title, company, emails, phone, mobile, fax, website, the full address broken into street, building, unit, postal code, city and country, plus WeChat, LinkedIn, the VAT number, industry, notes, the event tag, your lead rating and interests, and any translation you saved. The test record is flagged `isTest` so your workflow can ignore it.

- **The card photo is never sent.** It would be far larger than most services accept, and a picture is no use to a CRM field anyway.
- The address must begin with **https://**. Services like Zapier put a secret token in the URL itself, so treat the whole address as a password — and cardlio refuses plain `http://` for that reason.
- Cards are posted **as they are saved**, not retroactively. Switching the webhook on does not send your existing library.
- If a post fails, cardlio does **not** retry. A duplicate lead is more annoying than a missing one, and a retry loop against a mistyped address could hammer a stranger's server.

Where it goes afterwards

Once a card reaches the address you entered, what happens to it is governed by whoever runs that service — Zapier, Make, or you — and no longer by cardlio. We never see it, and no server of ours sits in the path. Switching the toggle off stops it immediately.

Caller ID — who's calling

A scanned card usually sits quietly in your library until you go looking for it. **Caller ID** changes that: when someone whose card you scanned rings your iPhone, their **name and company appear on the incoming call** instead of an unknown number — without adding a single one of them to your Contacts.

That last part is the point. Most card scanners insist on writing every scan into your address book, which is exactly how a phone ends up with a thousand contacts you never chose. cardlio keeps its own library and simply lends the numbers to the phone.

Switching it on

- In cardlio: **Settings → Caller ID → Name incoming calls**.
- Then in iOS: **Settings → Apps → Phone → Call Blocking & Identification**, and switch on **cardlio Caller ID**. This second step is iOS's own permission — no app can do it for you, which is why cardlio links you straight there.

After that it maintains itself: cardlio refreshes the list whenever you open the app, so cards scanned on your Mac or another device start naming callers too. **Update now** in the same Settings section forces a refresh if you'd rather not wait.

What it does and doesn't do

- **Your Contacts always win.** iPhone looks in your own address book first, so anyone already saved there shows their Contacts name and cardlio stays out of the way. cardlio names the people your phone book doesn't know — which is the point, since it never fills your Contacts with hundreds of scans.
- It works for **mobile and office numbers**. Fax numbers are left out.
- A number cardlio can't read confidently is **left out rather than guessed** — showing the wrong person's name on a call would be worse than showing none.
- If two people share a switchboard number, the number is listed **once**.
- **Nothing leaves your iPhone.** The numbers go into a system database on the device. cardlio is never told that a call happened, who called, or when — iOS looks up the name itself, and the app isn't even running.
- Turning the switch off clears the list immediately.

Testing it on yourself? Call from a number that is NOT in your Contacts — otherwise you'll see the Contacts name and think it isn't working. And if you run another caller-ID app, both offer names for the same call; which one iPhone shows is out of any app's hands.

Caller ID is iPhone-only — iPadOS and macOS have no equivalent — but the numbers come from your whole synced library, so a card scanned on your Mac names callers on your phone.

Cards in Contacts — without syncing

Caller ID names the call; it does not let you look somebody up in Phone, Mail or Messages. **Settings → Contacts → Show cards in Contacts** does: your cards appear in the Contacts app as **cardlio's own list**, so every app that searches contacts finds them — and **nothing is added to your iCloud, Google or Outlook contacts**. iOS asks once whether cardlio may add its contacts as its own list.

- The list is **read-only** and follows your library: edit a card in cardlio and Contacts catches up when you next open or leave cardlio.
- Name, company, job title, emails, phone numbers, address and website. Your rating, interests and notes stay in cardlio.
- It stays on the device. **Switch it off and the cards are gone from Contacts** at once.
- Want them in your real address book instead — editable and on every device? That is what **Office 365**, **Google Contacts** and **Save to Contacts** are for.

iCloud sync

Cards sync across your devices through your **private iCloud database** — only you can see them. Sign into the same Apple ID on each device and new scans and edits propagate automatically in the background. There is no server that we operate; sync is entirely Apple's CloudKit.

Your cards in a browser

Sometimes the iPhone is in your pocket and the Mac at home: a Windows PC at work, an Android phone, a shared screen. Open **team.cardlio.app**, sign in with the same Apple Account, and **My cards** shows your whole library, read straight from your private iCloud. Nothing passes through a server of ours.

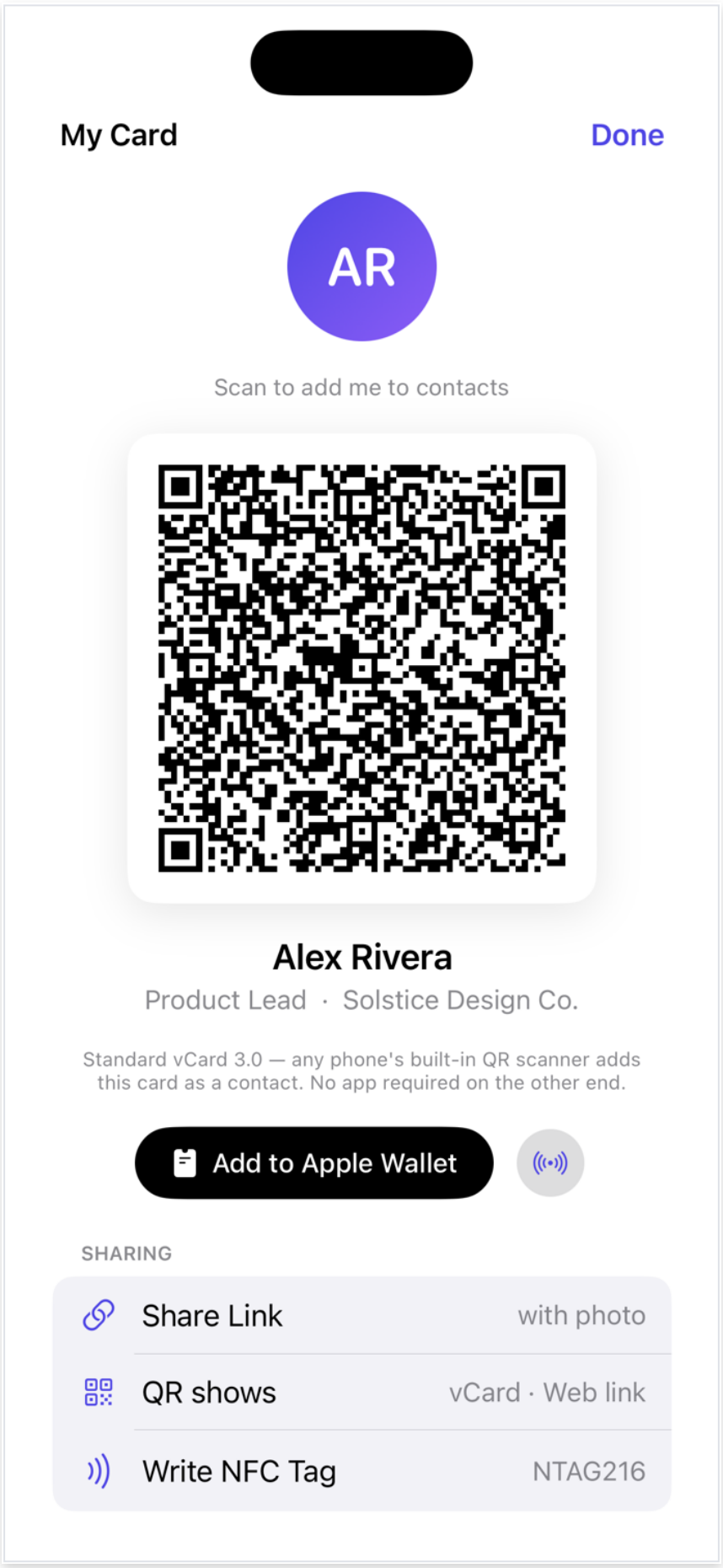
- **Find anyone** — search every field, filter by event, lead rating, follow-up owed, reconnect due, country or industry, switch between cards and a list, and open a card for every detail and its photo.
- **Change what a call changes** — the **lead rating**, the **event**, a **note** (a new line with the date; or the whole text under **Edit details**, together with title, company, industry, website, LinkedIn, WeChat and interests), **I owe a follow-up** and **Mark done**, **I was in touch**, and **Keep in touch** every 3, 6 or 12 months. Tick several cards to rate them or set their event in one go. The change reaches your iPhone and Mac a moment later. Names, numbers, e-mail addresses, the postal address, photos, "Owe again", and adding or deleting cards stay in the app: the app checks and formats those.
- **Sort by company** to see your cards grouped by company, and an opened card names the others you know there.
- **Today** — when something is due, the page opens with the follow-ups you owe and the people it is time to reconnect with. **Email** opens a draft in your own mail program: a plain one, or one written under the app's drafting rules by Claude or Gemini with your own key (only when you press Draft with AI). **Remind me** saves a calendar entry that Outlook, Google Calendar or Apple Calendar opens — handy where there is no Reminders app.
- **Downloads come with the unlock** — contacts as vCard, a spreadsheet (CSV), everything as a ZIP, or a printed list. The app leaves a small "unlocked" marker in your own iCloud for the page; bought already? Open cardlio once on that device, then reload.
- **Photos** on the web are small preview copies the app makes of each card's photo. After updating cardlio, leave the app open for a few minutes so it can prepare them for the cards you already have.
- **Overview** — the chart button beside the list view: cards added month by month, how warm your leads are, follow-ups and keep-in-touch, and your top countries, industries, companies and events. A click on a bar shows those cards.
- **Map** — the pin button beside Overview: your cards on Apple Maps, at the place the app found for each address. Click a pin to open the card; a cluster zooms in, and cards at one address are listed under the map. Apple Maps loads only when you open the map, and the pins are drawn in your browser — Apple sees the map you look at, not your cards.
- **Cards in this area** — on the map, move to a city and press it: the cards there become a filter ("Around Oslo"), so the list, print, downloads and the selection work on just those people. Handy before a trip.
- **Prepare** — on an open card: a one-page brief to read before a call or a visit — role, how to reach them, where you met, the lead rating and interests, what is owed and when you were last in touch, your notes, and the others you know at that company. Print it if you like.

- **Show QR** — on an open card: the contact as a QR code on screen. Point a phone's camera at it to add the person to the phone's contacts, without a file or an email. The code carries the name, company, title, one email, the phone numbers and the website; it is made in your browser.
- **Talking points** — on the brief: with your own Claude or Gemini key, the page looks up the company's recent news and suggests three openers that tie it to your notes. It sends the company, its website and industry, the title, the place, the event, the interests and your notes — never the person's name. A point that relies on news links to the page it came from.
- **Local time** — the brief, the Today list and the map's address list show the time where each person is ("Thu 15:42 in Tokyo · working hours"), and Today says how many of them are in working hours right now.
- **Events and companies** — at the end of the Overview: your fairs on a ring, and around each the companies you met there; a company you met at several fairs sits in the middle. Click a fair or a company to see its cards.
- **Event recap** — pick an event and a short summary sits above its cards: how many and when, how warm, what is still owed, where they come from. Print it, or download that event's cards, for the report after the fair.
- **Share to team** — copy the details of the cards you tick (or the one you have open) into one of your teams. The photo stays behind: a browser cannot upload it to iCloud. Cards the team already has are skipped.

Your teams sit on the same page, next to My cards.

Sharing your card — link, QR, NFC, Wallet & signature

Create **My Card** with your own details and hand it out any way the moment calls for. Nothing is required on the other end — no app, no account. You can keep **multiple cards** — Work, Personal, a side project — and switch with the selector above the QR; every share method (link, QR, NFC, Wallet, widget) presents the selected card, and all cards sync across your devices.



My Card: scan the QR, tap the NFC tag, or add the card to Apple Wallet.

- **Share Link** — sends a cardlio.app link (including your photo) through Messages, Mail, or AirDrop. Opening it shows your card in the browser with an Add to Contacts button. Your details are encoded inside the link itself — in the part of the address that browsers never send to any server — so nobody but the recipient ever sees them.
- **QR code** — the on-screen QR shows the compact web link by default (the same page an NFC tag opens); the toggle switches to a standard vCard 3.0 that any phone's camera imports fully offline.
- **QR widget** (iPhone) — add the **My Card QR** widget to your Home Screen for a scannable code at a glance, or to the Lock Screen for a one-tap jump to your full-screen QR. Find “cardlio” in the widget gallery.
- **Contact photo** — after picking a photo, drag and zoom it to sit perfectly in the circle; the **Adjust…** button re-crops it any time.
- **NFC tag** — write your card link to an **NTAG216** tag. A tap on an iPhone (XS or newer), or on any other phone that reads NFC, opens your card straight from the lock screen. Smaller tags usually don't have enough memory; the app tells you when a tag is too small.
- **Apple Wallet** — one tap on **Add to Apple Wallet** puts your card in Wallet on iPhone, with the QR on the front — no setup or certificates needed. Creating the pass needs a connection; afterwards it works offline forever. On the Mac, cardlio builds the pass file so you can AirDrop it to your iPhone.
- **Send me your details** — the page someone opens from your link also offers them a short form: name, title, company, email, phone. It opens their own email or messages app with a message to you, laid out like a signature — paste it into **Paste Signature** and it becomes a card. Nothing goes through cardlio; the page only builds the message.
- **Email Signature** — turns your card into an e-mail signature: name, title, company, phone, e-mail, website, optionally your address, photo and a QR code, and a **Save my contact** link to your card page. **Copy Signature**, then paste it where your mail app keeps signatures — the sheet lists the place in Mail, Outlook and Gmail. In Mail on the Mac, untick “Always match my default message font” or the layout is dropped. Gmail does not keep pasted pictures: add the QR code with Gmail's image button, from **More ▸ Share QR Code Image**. The QR code carries a short contact card (name, company, title, one phone, e-mail, website) so a phone camera can read it straight off a screen.
- **Call Background** — a full-HD (1920 × 1080) background for Zoom, Teams and Google Meet: your name, title and company in one upper corner and a QR code in the other, where your head does not cover them. Choose colour, dark or light — the colour follows your card's accent — and the side for the code. On a Mac, Control Center ▸ Video Effects ▸ Background can use it in FaceTime and other camera apps too. Zoom mirrors your own preview, so the text looks backwards to you; everyone else sees it the right way round.

NFC tags and QR codes carry a compact card without the photo — tags are tiny. Links from the Share Link button include it.

Card style picks how your shared page looks to the receiver: an accent colour (free) and a page layout — Classic, Banner, Minimal, or Bold (layouts are premium). The style travels inside the link itself, so nothing about you is uploaded anywhere — and older links you've already printed or written to tags simply keep the classic look.

Siri, Shortcuts & Control Center

Your library is available to Siri and the Shortcuts app as building blocks (iPhone and iPad; the export action also works in Shortcuts on the Mac):

- Say **“Scan a card in cardlio”** to jump straight into the scanner, or **“Open a card in cardlio”** and pick the contact.
- The **Open Card** action deep-links to any card — the picker searches your library by name, company, or email.
- **Export Card as vCard** hands a .vcf file to the rest of your shortcut — save it to Files, attach it to an email, feed it to any action that accepts files (premium, like all exports).
- A **Scan Card** button is also available for Control Center — scanning is two taps from anywhere.

iOS 27 and macOS 27

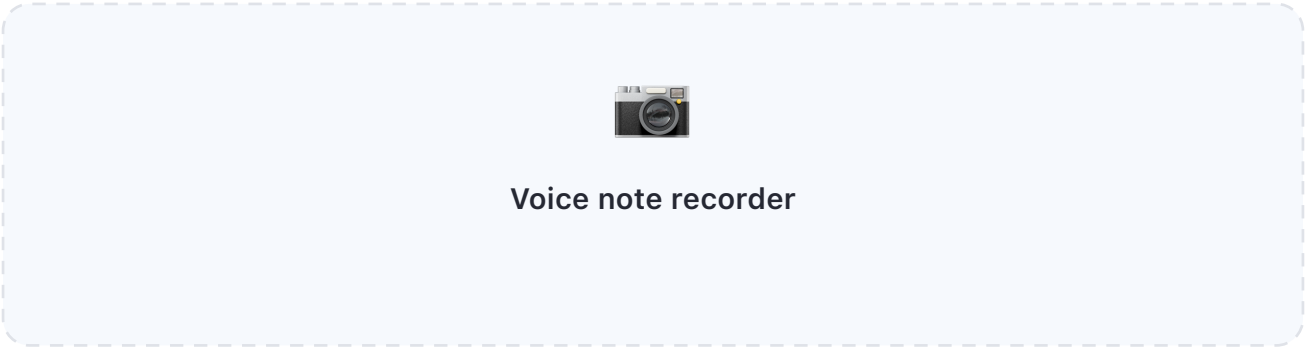
- **Siri knows your cards as people.** Ask "who did I meet at the expo who does logistics?" and Siri answers from your library; say "text the person from Tristar" and the card goes straight to Messages (Mail on the Mac). With a card open, "text this person" just works. It is the same index Spotlight already keeps — nothing leaves your device.
- **Point the camera at a card** (iPhone). Hold the Camera Control or open visual intelligence, tap the **picture-with-magnifier button** at the bottom right (the unlabelled Search — the speech bubble is Ask), and cardlio appears with the name and company already read. Tap it and the review sheet opens with every card on that frame — nothing is saved until you have looked at it.
- **Ask your network** searches your cards itself, then answers from what it found — written by Apple's larger model when Private Cloud Compute is your provider. Every answer still points at real cards.

Voice notes

Say a few words about the person — "met at the expo, wants pricing for the Rotterdam office" — and cardlio writes it into the card's Notes, tidied into short bullet points.

- **Where** — **Record Context** under each card in the review screen, or the **microphone** beside Notes in a card's editor. On iPhone and Mac.
- **Hold** the microphone while you speak, **or tap** it to start and tap again to stop. Up to 30 seconds. VoiceOver users get a single Record / Stop action.

- **Names come out right.** cardlio already knows whose card it is, so the person's name and company are spelled as printed on the card, not as the speech recogniser guessed them — "Halvorsen", not "Hal Vawson".
- You see what was heard and the bullet points before anything is added — change the text, or discard it.
- Transcription runs **on your device**, and so does the summary (Apple Intelligence). Without Apple Intelligence your words are added as spoken. No audio is kept, and nothing is uploaded.
- A Mac without a built-in microphone (Mac mini, Mac Studio) needs a headset or an external microphone.

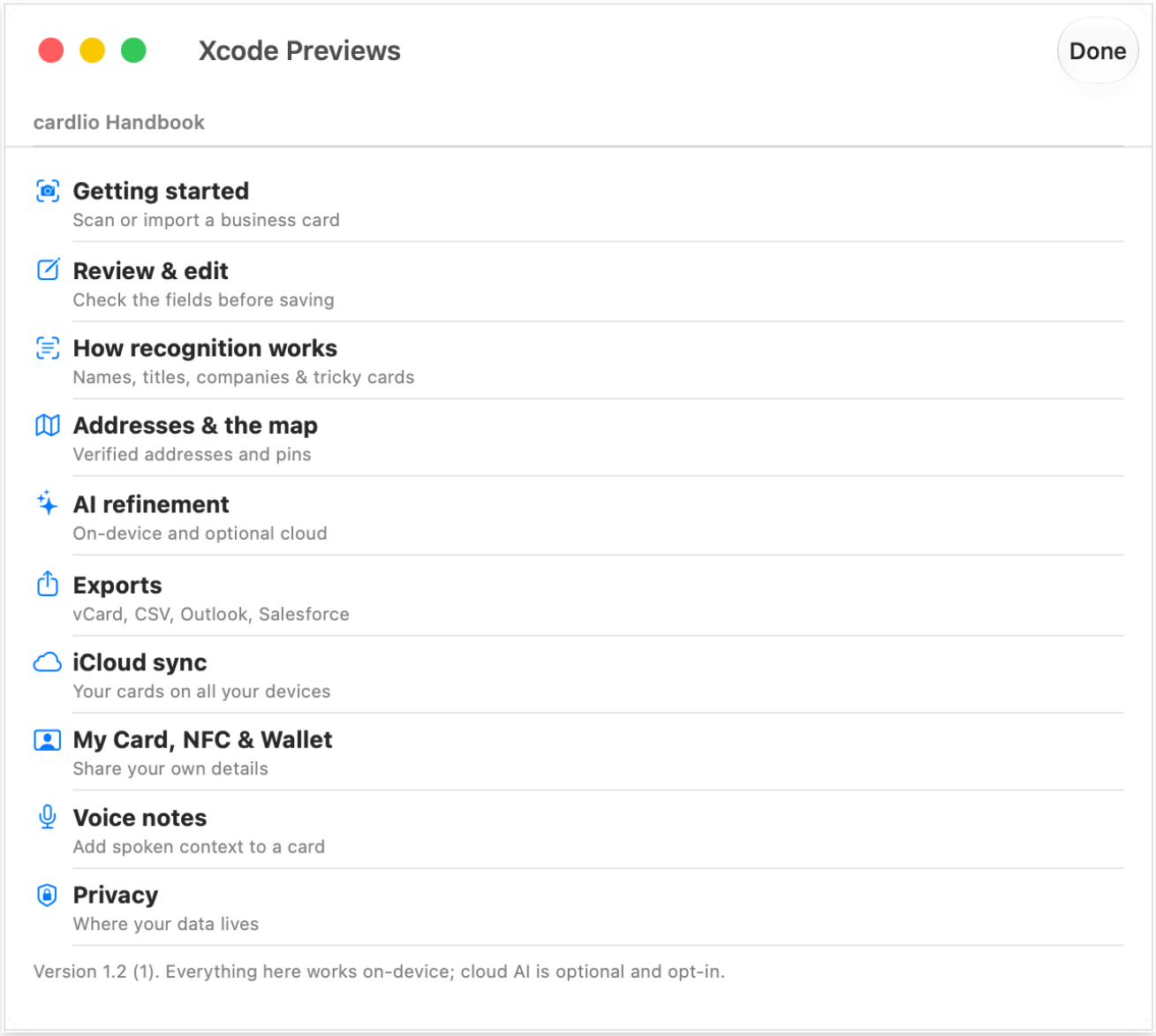


Screenshot unavailable — the recorder is a live-audio flow best captured on a device.

The in-app handbook

A shorter version of this guide is built into the app. Open it any time from the Help (?) button on Mac, or the Handbook item in the menu on iPhone and iPad. It works offline and always matches the version you're running.

On the Mac, the **Help menu** has both: **cardlio Help** (⌘?) opens the built-in guide, and **User Guide (PDF)** opens this document on cardlio.app.



The in-app handbook — the same topics, one tap away inside cardlio.

Privacy & your data

cardlio is built to keep your contacts yours:

- OCR, parsing, and on-device AI all run **locally** on your device.
- Sync uses **your private iCloud** — there is no server we operate.
- **team.cardlio.app** reads your cards from your own iCloud, in your browser, after Apple's sign-in — we never see them. For it, the app keeps a small preview of each card's photo and, if you bought the unlock, an "unlocked" marker in that same private iCloud.
- Cloud AI and address lookup are opt-in: Claude and Gemini run only with your own key, and Apple Private Cloud Compute only when you choose it as your provider (Apple keeps nothing).
- **Check in VIES** runs only when you tap it, and sends only the card's VAT number to the EU Commission's VAT service.

- **Who is this?** runs only when you tap it, and sends a person's name, company, title, website and city to Claude or Gemini under your key — never their email address or phone numbers.
- API keys live in the **Keychain** and never sync off your device unless you enable iCloud Keychain.
- Shared card links carry your card **inside the link itself** — no server ever receives it. Creating a Wallet pass sends your card once to the signing service, which stores and logs nothing.
- **Office 365 sync** sends contacts only to your own Microsoft account, using permissions you grant at sign-in; the sign-in token lives in the Keychain, and we never see your Microsoft credentials or your contacts.
- **Translation** runs on-device. Card text is never uploaded to translate it.
- **Caller ID** hands numbers to a system database on your iPhone. cardlio is never told who called.
- **Cards in Contacts** (optional) shows your cards in the iPhone's Contacts app as a separate, read-only list kept on the device. Nothing is added to your iCloud, Google or Outlook contacts.
- **App lock** (optional) — **Settings → App lock** (on the Mac, Settings → General) hides your cards until you unlock with Face ID, Touch ID or your passcode: when cardlio opens, and when you come back after the time you choose — immediately, or after 1, 5 or 15 minutes. The Mac also locks when it sleeps or its screen locks. The app switcher never shows your cards. Spotlight, Siri and Caller ID keep working while it is locked, and the setting applies to that device only.
- The Mac's **local address reader** reads cards on your Mac. Its only network use is the one-time download of the model from cardlio's page on GitHub, each file checked before it is installed.

Crash reports

If cardlio ever crashes or freezes, iOS and macOS hand the app a technical report about it. cardlio keeps those **on your device only** — you'll find them under **Help → Diagnostics**, with the number of reports and when the last one arrived.

Nothing is uploaded automatically, and there is no analytics service in cardlio. If you'd like to help fix a crash you hit, that screen has **Email to Support**, which attaches the report to a message to support@cardlio.app — and **Share** to send it any other way, or just to read it yourself. **Delete Reports** clears them. If the section says there's nothing to report, that's good news, not a malfunction.

Tips & troubleshooting

- **Sharpest scans:** fill the frame with the card, keep it flat and well-lit, and avoid glare.
- **Badge glare?** A badge inside a clear lanyard pouch reflects venue lighting straight back at the camera. Slide it out if you can, or tilt it away from the light — moving closer usually makes it worse, not better.

- **Cards missed or over-detected?** Adjust **Detection confidence** in Settings (Mac: Settings → General). Lower it to catch faint, glary, or unusually designed cards; raise it to reject things that aren't cards. Default is 75%.
- **A field looks wrong?** Tap to edit — the fix saves immediately and future scans aren't affected.
- **Map is blank?** Pins and tiles need a network connection; addresses still verify and store their coordinates.
- **Card not syncing?** Confirm the same Apple ID and that iCloud Drive is enabled on each device.
- **Duplicates piling up?** Open the Duplicates tool to review and merge matches.